



Incident report analysis

Instructions

As you continue through this course, you may use this template to record your findings after completing an activity or to take notes on what you've learned about a specific tool or concept. You can also use this chart as a way to practice applying the NIST framework to different situations you encounter.

Summary	The company experienced a two-hour ICMP-based DoS attack. The attacker sent a large number of ICMP packets through a misconfigured firewall, overwhelming the network and preventing normal internal traffic from accessing network resources. The incident response team blocked incoming ICMP traffic, took non-critical services offline, and restored critical services.
Identify	The main security risk was a misconfigured firewall that allowed excessive incoming ICMP traffic. The affected network services and systems should be identified, and regular audits should be performed on firewalls, network devices, systems, and access controls.
Protect	Configure the firewall to limit the rate of incoming ICMP packets and verify source IP addresses to detect spoofed traffic. Implement IDS/IPS controls to filter suspicious ICMP traffic and keep network security configurations updated.
Detect	Use network monitoring software and IDS/IPS to detect abnormal traffic patterns, including unusually high volumes of ICMP packets. Security alerts should notify the security team of potential DoS activity.

Respond	Block malicious ICMP traffic and isolate affected resources. Take non-critical network services offline and restore critical services. Analyze network logs and determine how the attacker exploited the firewall vulnerability.
Recover	Restore affected network services to normal operation and verify that critical systems are functioning correctly. Fix the firewall configuration and update security procedures to reduce the risk of another ICMP DoS attack.

Reflections/Notes: This incident showed the importance of properly configuring firewalls and continuously monitoring network traffic. The NIST CSF provides a structured approach for identifying vulnerabilities, protecting systems, detecting attacks, responding to incidents, and recovering from them.